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# Online Image vs Real Life

*When you feel 'fake'*

4 psychology approaches · by EvaTalk

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## TO BEGIN

# When you feel 'fake'

Every creator lives a gap between their online image (curated, edited) and their real life. That's normal — but when this gap feels like a lie, it creates distress: the feeling of being 'fake'.

This guide helps you reconcile your two sides, without erasing or exposing everything.

## YOUR INTENTION

The gap you feel between your online image and your real life: \_\_\_\_\_

## A normal gap... up to a point

Selecting and polishing what you show is normal (no one shows everything). The problem isn't the gap itself, but when it grows so wide that it feels like lying and cuts you off from yourself.

Understanding this de-guils curation... while alerting you if the gap grows too wide.

### Example

*Sami felt like an impostor; understanding some curation is normal, but HIS gap was too wide, helped him adjust.*

### Measure the gap

Is your image/reality gap normal polishing, or a chasm that weighs on you?

### The right dose

Write: 'Some curation is normal; too wide a gap isn't.'

*Takeaway — Some curation is healthy; a huge gap, though, cuts you off from yourself.*

## 'I'm an impostor'

'I'm a walking lie', 'my real life is disappointing', 'if they knew, they'd leave': these thoughts turn ordinary curation into shame of yourself.

Reframing them helps you inhabit your content without disowning yourself.

### Example

*'Everything about me is fake' overwhelmed Léa, until she saw she could show more truth without revealing everything.*

### Spot the shame

Note a thought making you feel 'fake' · a fairer version.

### More truth

Write: 'I can show more truth without exposing everything.'

*Takeaway — Showing a polished version isn't lying — unless you disown yourself.*

## Reconcile your two sides

You don't have to be perfect online or reveal everything offline: you have the right to be a real, imperfect person, on both sides. Reconciling your image and your reality makes you more serene — and more endearing.

Authenticity is alignment, not total exposure.

### Example

*By showing more of her real highs and lows, Nia finally felt aligned — and closer to her audience.*

### My two sides

What would reconcile you with your online image?

### Real and imperfect

Write: 'I have the right to be real and imperfect, on both sides.'

*Takeaway — Authenticity is alignment between you and your image — not perfection.*

## Narrow the gap

In practice: gradually align your content with your reality (show a bit more truth), spot what in your 'persona' truly serves you vs exhausts you, and tighten the gap where it hurts. The smaller the gap, the more whole you feel.

You don't have to show everything — just not betray yourself.

### Example

*By weaving in more authentic moments, Karim narrowed the gap that gnawed at him, without sacrificing anything.*

### Narrow the gap

One truer thing you could show, without revealing everything: \_\_\_\_\_

### My persona

Write: 'I keep what serves me, I drop what exhausts me.'

*Takeaway — Tighten the gap where it hurts: alignment soothes.*

## Key takeaways

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- Some curation is normal; a huge gap cuts you off from yourself.
- Showing a polished version isn't lying — unless you disown yourself.
- You have the right to be real and imperfect, on both sides.
- Authenticity is alignment, not perfection.
- Gradually align your content with your reality.
- Keep what serves you in your persona, drop what exhausts you.

## Your turn

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### My gap

| Normal polishing or a weighing chasm? | The 'fake' thought |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------|
|                                       |                    |
|                                       |                    |
|                                       |                    |
|                                       |                    |

### Reconcile

| What would reconcile me | Narrow the gap / my persona |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                         |                             |
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|                         |                             |



YOUR JOURNEY

## Your 4-week plan

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**Week 1**

Measure my image/reality gap.

**Week 2**

Reframe 'I'm an impostor'.

**Week 3**

Reconcile my two sides.

**Week 4**

Narrow the gap where it weighs.

YOUR PLAN

## Your action plan

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My 'I have the right to be real' line:

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What would reconcile me:

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What truer thing I'd show:

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*Align yourself: authenticity isn't perfection, it's consistency.*

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not therapy. A creator's life can be draining: if you feel overwhelmed, a professional (psychologist) can help. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.